PROMISE & PRACTICE · DEEP DIVE · SOURCE ANALYSIS

The Impeachment of Johnson — A House Divided

One Vote From Removal

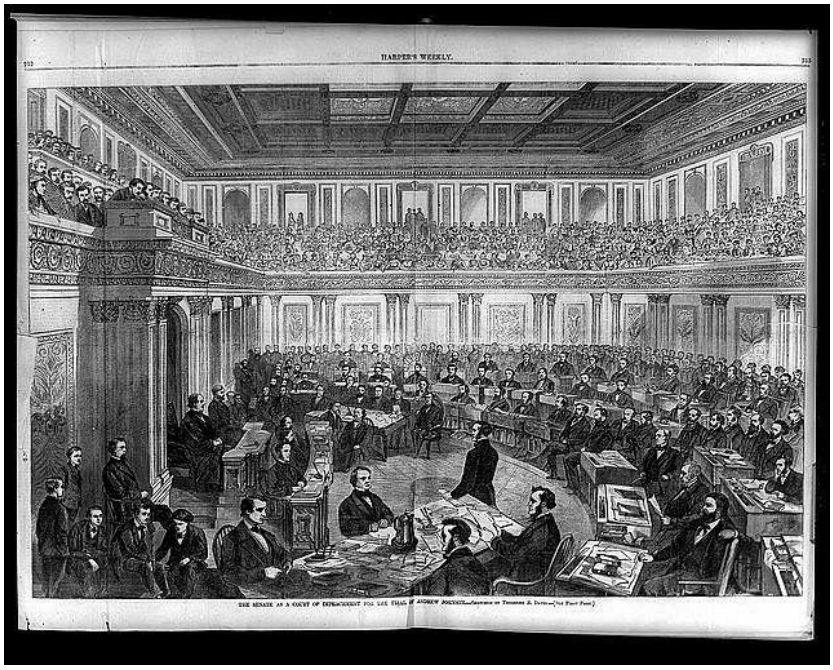
Name: _____ **Period:** _____ **Date:** _____

WHAT I CAN DO TODAY I can read primary sources about The Impeachment of Johnson — A House Divided, weigh who made each one and why, and use evidence to answer historical questions.

Directions. Trace the chain of events — and weigh the effects of the choice the Senate made

THE SOURCES

THE IMAGE · 1868 — The impeachment trial



"The Senate as a Court of Impeachment for the Trial of President Andrew Johnson" — wood engraving, Harper's Weekly, 1868, public domain (Library of Congress).

SOURCE · THE SENATOR'S REASONING — Why some voted to acquit

> *"I cannot agree to destroy the harmonious working of the Constitution for the sake of getting rid of an unacceptable President."*
> *— Sen. Lyman Trumbull, 1868. Public domain*

— Sen. Lyman Trumbull, 1868. Public domain.

YOUR WORK

QUESTION 1 STEP 1 · BUILD THE CHAIN

Number these 1–5: (a) the Senate acquits Johnson by one vote · (b) Congress passes the Tenure of Office Act · (c) Johnson and Congress clash over Reconstruction · (d) the House impeaches Johnson · (e) Johnson fires Secretary Stanton.

QUESTION 2 STEP 2 · THE REAL CAUSE

Firing Stanton was the legal trigger, but what was the deeper cause of the impeachment fight?

- ☐ A. a personal insult
- ☐ B. a disagreement about taxes
- ☐ C. who would control Reconstruction and whether freedpeople's rights would be protected
- ☐ D. a foreign war

QUESTION 3 STEP 3 · WHY SOME ACQUITTED

Seven Republicans voted to acquit even though they opposed Johnson. Using Trumbull's words, explain their reasoning. What were they afraid of?

QUESTION 4 STEP 4 · THE EFFECTS

In three or four sentences, describe the effects of the acquittal — both for Johnson's remaining time in office and for the balance of power between presidents and Congress ever since.

TEACHER ANSWER KEY — The Impeachment of Johnson — A House Divided

QUESTION 1: Open response.

Look for a response along the lines of: "1 = ___ 2 = ___ 3 = ___ 4 = ___ 5 = ___"

QUESTION 2: **Correct — C. who would control Reconstruction and whether freedpeople's rights would be protected**

Right. The firing was the excuse; the real battle was over who would control Reconstruction and whether freedpeople's rights would be protected.

QUESTION 3: Open response.

Look for a response along the lines of: "They acquitted because they feared..."

QUESTION 4: Open response.

Look for a response along the lines of: "In the short term...; in the long term..."